

DSAT Practice — Claim–Example Match

25 Original MCQs | Questions Only

Q1.

[Easy]

The Hollow by the River is a 1923 novel by Margaret Ellison. In the novel, the character Thornton is portrayed as solitary yet dependable—someone who prefers quiet isolation but will unfailingly assist his friends in times of need: _____

Which quotation from *The Hollow by the River* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) "'Past the ridge the land turns to marshes,' said Collings. 'Nobody goes that far, and nobody ought to.'"
 - B) "Thornton opened the door only a crack, scowling at the interruption, but the moment he saw how weary they looked he swung it wide, pulled them inside, and set about warming soup without another word of complaint."
 - C) "Pemberton dropped his fishing rod on the bank, threw his hat after it, and sat down heavily to watch the ferry disappear around the bend."
 - D) "Whitmore had spent the whole of the morning sweeping the cottage and airing out the blankets."
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Q2.

[Easy]

Urban planner Carla Reyes has claimed that pedestrian-friendly street redesigns increase foot traffic to local businesses.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Reyes's claim?

- A) A survey found that most drivers prefer streets with multiple vehicle lanes over streets with wider sidewalks.
 - B) Retail sales at shops on a street redesigned with wider sidewalks and reduced vehicle lanes increased by 18 percent in the year following the redesign.
 - C) Cities that invested in pedestrian infrastructure spent more on road maintenance than cities that did not.
 - D) Local business owners on streets scheduled for redesign expressed concern about potential revenue losses during construction.
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Q3.

[Easy]

Educator Samuel Yoon has argued that integrating visual art activities into elementary mathematics instruction helps students grasp abstract geometric concepts more quickly.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Yoon's claim?

- A) A survey of parents found that most believed art classes were less important than mathematics classes.
 - B) Art teachers at elementary schools reported that students who excelled in mathematics also tended to produce more detailed artwork.
 - C) Students who drew and colored geometric shapes as part of their math lessons scored higher on a subsequent geometry test than students who received traditional instruction without art activities.
 - D) Schools that allocated more funding to art supplies saw an overall increase in student enrollment.
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Q4.

[Easy]

Gilt and Gravel is a 1931 novel by Dorothy Ashford. The narrator describes the character Estelle as someone perpetually dissatisfied with her current circumstances and eager to project an image of wealth she does not possess: _____

Which quotation from the novel most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) "Roland crossed the room three times before he managed to sit down, his hands shaking with a mixture of disbelief and happiness that he could not conceal."
 - B) "The moment Estelle fastened the borrowed pearls around her neck, her entire bearing shifted: she straightened, lifted her chin, and spoke in a clipped, airy tone that bore no resemblance to the voice she used at the shop counter."
 - C) "My mother once told me that ambition was a kind of sickness, and I have spent the years since wondering whether she was right."
 - D) "The landlady's cat slept on the radiator all winter and moved to the windowsill each May with the regularity of a clock."
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Q5.

[Easy]

Marine biologist Kira Tanaka has argued that the decline of kelp forests along the Pacific coast is primarily caused by the overpopulation of sea urchins, which graze on kelp holdfast structures.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Tanaka's claim?

- A) Water temperature increases along the Pacific coast coincided with the period of kelp forest decline.
 - B) Kelp forests in the Atlantic Ocean, where sea urchins are less common, also experienced declines during the same period.
 - C) Sea urchins in laboratory settings preferred to consume algae species other than kelp when given a choice.
 - D) Coastal areas where sea urchin populations were experimentally reduced showed significantly faster kelp forest recovery than areas where sea urchin populations were left unmanaged.
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Q6.

[Easy]

Historian Margaret Chen has argued that the construction of transcontinental railroads in the nineteenth century accelerated the cultural integration of previously isolated communities in the American West.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Chen's claim?

- A) The cost of shipping goods by railroad was higher than the cost of shipping goods by river barge.
 - B) Railroad companies employed workers from diverse ethnic backgrounds during the construction period.
 - C) Towns along newly completed railroad routes adopted fashions, foods, and customs from distant regions more quickly than towns without railroad access.
 - D) Several transcontinental railroad projects exceeded their original construction budgets.
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Q7.

[Easy]

Psychologist Dara Okafor has claimed that exposure to natural environments reduces symptoms of attention fatigue more effectively than exposure to urban environments.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Okafor's claim?

- A) Participants who took a 30-minute walk in a wooded park performed significantly better on a subsequent attention test than participants who walked for the same duration along a busy city street.
 - B) Participants who lived in rural areas reported lower overall stress levels than participants who lived in cities.
 - C) Participants who took walks in urban environments reported enjoying the walks as much as participants who took walks in parks.
 - D) Attention fatigue is more commonly diagnosed in adults than in children.
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Q8.

[Easy]

Nutritionist Leila Farid has argued that replacing refined grains with whole grains in school lunch programs would improve students' sustained attention during afternoon classes.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Farid's claim?

- A) Students who consumed whole-grain lunches maintained more consistent blood sugar levels and performed better on afternoon focus assessments than students who consumed refined-grain lunches.
 - B) Parents of elementary school students preferred that schools offer whole-grain bread over white bread.
 - C) Whole-grain products are more expensive per serving than refined-grain products in most school districts.
 - D) Students who skipped lunch entirely performed worse on afternoon assessments than students who ate lunch.
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Q9.

[Medium]

Sociologist Franklin Hayes has argued that the proliferation of social media platforms has not diminished the quality of civic discourse, as many critics contend, but has instead expanded the range of voices participating in public debates.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Hayes's argument?

- A) Researchers determined that the majority of political posts on a major social media platform received fewer than ten interactions.
 - B) A survey found that social media users spent an average of two hours per day on platforms, compared with one hour per day five years earlier.
 - C) A longitudinal study found that social media users from historically underrepresented demographic groups reported significantly greater participation in political discussions after adopting social media than before.
 - D) A study found that television news viewers and social media users held similar levels of factual knowledge about current events.
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Q10.

[Medium]

A Gathering of Seasons is a 2003 novel by Anya Breckenridge. In the novel, the protagonist, Elara, is characterized as someone whose outward composure masks a deep internal turbulence: _____

Which quotation from A Gathering of Seasons most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) "Elara folded her napkin precisely, aligned her silverware, and answered each question with the practiced calm of someone who had learned, long ago, that the tremor in her hands was visible only to herself."
 - B) "The garden had grown wild in her absence, and she resolved to spend the entire weekend pulling weeds and trimming hedges."
 - C) "Elara's brother arrived unannounced, carrying a suitcase and wearing the sheepish grin she remembered from their childhood."
 - D) "The train was late, and the other passengers shifted restlessly on the platform, checking their watches every few minutes."
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Q11.

[Medium]

Ecologist Naomi Sutherland has proposed that the introduction of beaver populations into degraded stream ecosystems accelerates the recovery of native fish species.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Sutherland's proposal?

- A) Streams with beaver dams contained more sediment than streams without dams, reducing water clarity.
 - B) Beavers in captive breeding programs reproduced at higher rates than wild beavers in undegraded streams.
 - C) Native fish populations in streams with beaver dams fluctuated seasonally but did not show a long-term trend.
 - D) Streams where beavers were reintroduced showed a 40 percent increase in native trout populations within three years, while comparable streams without beavers showed no significant change.
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Q12.

[Medium]

In the *Stillness of Snow* is a 1987 novel by Evelyn Moreau. The narrator describes the character Henrik as someone who uses humor to deflect from emotional vulnerability: _____

Which quotation from *In the Stillness of Snow* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) "Henrik worked through the night, finishing the repairs to the barn roof before the first snow arrived."
 - B) "When Marta asked if he had been hurt by her leaving, Henrik laughed and said the only thing that hurt was the price of the locksmith, and then he looked away and said nothing more."
 - C) "The children loved Henrik because he always brought sweets and told stories about a talking fox who lived under the bridge."
 - D) "Henrik stood at the window and watched the snow fall for a long time without speaking."
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Q13.

[Medium]

Linguist Nora Fischer has argued that bilingual individuals who regularly switch between languages develop enhanced cognitive flexibility compared to monolingual individuals.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Fischer's argument?

- A) Bilingual participants who reported frequent daily code-switching scored significantly higher on tasks requiring rapid shifts between different problem-solving rules than monolingual participants did.
 - B) Bilingual participants had larger vocabularies in their dominant language than monolingual participants had in their only language.
 - C) Monolingual participants performed better than bilingual participants on a test of reading speed in their native language.
 - D) Bilingual participants reported higher levels of job satisfaction than monolingual participants in a workplace survey.
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Q14.

[Medium]

Agricultural scientist Obi Nwosu has argued that intercropping—planting two or more crop species together in the same field—can reduce pest damage without the use of chemical pesticides.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Nwosu's claim?

- A) Farmers who used chemical pesticides on monoculture fields reported higher yields than farmers who used no pesticides.
 - B) Fields where maize was intercropped with beans experienced 35 percent less stem borer damage than fields where maize was planted alone, with no pesticides applied in either condition.
 - C) Intercropped fields required more labor to harvest than monoculture fields.
 - D) The stem borer, a common maize pest, is attracted to the chemical compounds released by bean plants.
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Q15.

[Medium]

The art historian Vivian Osei has argued that the murals painted on the walls of ancient Minoan palaces were not merely decorative but served a political function, reinforcing the authority of the ruling class by depicting scenes of royal ceremony and divine favor.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Osei's argument?

- A) Similar mural styles have been found in domestic buildings occupied by non-elite Minoan residents.
 - B) The pigments used in Minoan murals were imported from distant regions, indicating extensive trade networks.
 - C) Murals in the most politically significant rooms of Minoan palaces—throne rooms and audience halls—disproportionately featured scenes of rulers receiving offerings from subjects and interacting with deities.
 - D) Many Minoan murals depict dolphins, flowers, and other natural subjects with no apparent political symbolism.
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Q16.

[Medium]

Public health researcher Amira Hassan has claimed that community-based exercise programs for older adults reduce the risk of falls more effectively than home-based exercise programs do.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Hassan's claim?

- A) The cost of operating community exercise programs was lower per participant than the cost of providing home-based exercise equipment.
 - B) Older adults who participated in community exercise programs reported higher levels of social satisfaction than those in home-based programs.
 - C) Older adults enrolled in supervised group exercise classes experienced 25 percent fewer falls over a one-year period than a matched group performing the same exercises independently at home.
 - D) Older adults who did not exercise at all experienced more falls than those in either type of exercise program.
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Q17.

[Medium]

Beneath the Surface is a 2011 novel by Tomás Restrepo. The narrator portrays the character Valentina as someone whose meticulous attention to detail in her professional life contrasts sharply with the disorder she tolerates in her personal life: _____

Which quotation from Beneath the Surface most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) "Valentina's colleagues admired her efficiency, and her supervisor frequently cited her as an example for new hires."
 - B) "At the office Valentina labeled every folder, color-coded every shelf, and kept a spotless desk; at home she stepped over piles of unopened mail and ate dinner standing at a counter crowded with unwashed mugs."
 - C) "She had always preferred working alone, finding the noise of open-plan offices an intolerable distraction."
 - D) "Valentina spent her weekends volunteering at the community garden, where she found the work both exhausting and satisfying."
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Q18.

[Medium]

Economist Sandra Liu has argued that raising the minimum wage in low-cost-of-living areas does not lead to significant job losses, contrary to predictions based on standard supply-and-demand models.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Liu's argument?

- A) Workers in high-cost-of-living areas reported higher job satisfaction than workers in low-cost-of-living areas.
 - B) Counties that raised the minimum wage experienced higher rates of inflation than counties that did not.
 - C) Counties with low living costs that raised their minimum wage by 15 percent saw no statistically significant change in employment levels over the following two years compared to similar counties that did not raise wages.
 - D) Standard supply-and-demand models accurately predicted employment changes in high-cost-of-living areas after minimum wage increases.
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Q19.

[Hard]

Philosopher Rebecca Stanton has argued that moral intuitions—the immediate, gut-level judgments people make about right and wrong—should be treated as data points that ethical theories must account for, not as infallible guides to moral truth. Stanton maintains that when an ethical theory conflicts with a strong moral intuition, neither should be automatically discarded; instead, the conflict should prompt careful re-examination of both the theory and the intuition.

Which of the following scenarios, if true, would most clearly exemplify the approach Stanton advocates?

- A) A philosopher encounters a case where a well-supported ethical framework yields a conclusion that most people find deeply objectionable, and responds by scrutinizing both the framework's assumptions and the cultural origins of the intuition before deciding which to revise.
 - B) A philosopher discards a longstanding ethical theory solely because it produces a single counterintuitive result.
 - C) A philosopher accepts all moral intuitions as correct and constructs an ethical theory designed to accommodate every one of them.
 - D) A philosopher argues that moral intuitions are entirely the product of evolutionary pressures and therefore have no relevance to ethical reasoning.
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Q20.

[Hard]

Archaeologist Dina Osman has proposed that a collection of small clay figurines excavated from a Neolithic settlement in Anatolia served a ritual function rather than a playful or artistic one.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Osman's proposal?

- A) The figurines were found exclusively in areas of the settlement associated with ceremonial activity, such as hearths surrounded by animal bones arranged in deliberate patterns, and none were found in domestic refuse deposits or children's burial sites.
 - B) Similar figurines have been found at Neolithic sites across a wide geographic area, indicating that the style was widespread.
 - C) Chemical analysis of the clay used for the figurines shows that it was sourced locally, within 5 kilometers of the settlement.
 - D) Some of the figurines had been broken, with the fragments scattered across the floor of the excavation area.
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Q21.

[Hard]

Musicologist Patricia Okafor has observed that West African drumming traditions influenced the development of syncopated rhythms in early jazz, but she emphasizes that this influence was not a simple transfer. Rather, Okafor argues, enslaved African musicians adapted West African rhythmic principles to the harmonic structures of European music they encountered in the Americas, creating a fundamentally new rhythmic language.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Okafor's characterization of the influence as an adaptation rather than a simple transfer?

- A) Syncopated rhythms appear in musical traditions from many cultures around the world, not only in those influenced by West Africa.
 - B) West African drumming traditions remained unchanged in communities that had no contact with European musical forms.
 - C) Many early jazz musicians had no formal training in European music theory.
 - D) Analysis of early jazz recordings reveals rhythmic patterns that combine West African polyrhythmic structures with the diatonic harmonic progressions of European hymn traditions, producing combinations not found in either tradition alone.
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Q22.

[Hard]

Behavioral economist Yuki Tanaka has argued that presenting nutritional information at the point of purchase—such as calorie counts displayed on restaurant menus—has a limited effect on consumers' food choices because most dining decisions are driven by habit and social context rather than by deliberate evaluation of nutritional data.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Tanaka's argument?

- A) Restaurants that displayed calorie counts experienced a decrease in customer volume compared to restaurants that did not.
 - B) A survey found that consumers generally preferred restaurants that did not display calorie counts on their menus.
 - C) Consumers who downloaded a nutrition-tracking app reduced their daily calorie intake over a three-month period.
 - D) A study found that restaurants that added calorie counts to their menus saw no statistically significant change in the average calorie content of meals ordered, even among customers who reported noticing and reading the calorie information.
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Q23.

[Hard]

The *Cartographer's Apprentice* is a 2015 novel by Ravi Deshmukh. The narrator characterizes the protagonist, Anand, as someone whose ambition is tempered by a persistent self-doubt that prevents him from fully committing to any course of action: _____

Which quotation from *The Cartographer's Apprentice* most effectively illustrates the claim?

- A) "By the time Anand arrived at the harbor, the ship had already departed, and he stood on the dock watching it shrink toward the horizon."
 - B) "The map room smelled of cedar and old ink, and Anand loved nothing more than spending a quiet afternoon tracing coastlines onto fresh vellum."
 - C) "Anand's mentor told him he had a gift for precision, and Anand nodded politely, already thinking about the errors he had not yet corrected."
 - D) "Anand drafted his resignation letter three times that evening, polishing each version until it gleamed with conviction, then folded all three into the desk drawer where they joined the others he had written and never sent."
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Q24.

[Hard]

Climate scientist Ingrid Holm has argued that the current generation of global climate models systematically underestimates the rate of Arctic sea ice loss because the models do not adequately represent the albedo feedback loop—the process by which melting ice exposes darker ocean water, which absorbs more solar radiation and accelerates further melting.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Holm's argument?

- A) Climate models that include detailed representations of ocean currents have improved their predictions of Antarctic ice sheet behavior.
 - B) Satellite observations over the past two decades show that Arctic sea ice has declined at roughly twice the rate predicted by the ensemble average of current global climate models, and the discrepancy is largest in regions where the albedo feedback loop is most active.
 - C) The albedo of Arctic sea ice has remained relatively constant over the past decade, according to satellite measurements.
 - D) Global climate models have accurately predicted average global temperature increases over the same period.
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Q25.

[Hard]

Neuroscientist Amara Okonkwo has proposed that sleep deprivation impairs moral judgment by weakening activity in the prefrontal cortex, the brain region most associated with evaluating the consequences of actions. Okonkwo argues that this impairment is specific to consequentialist reasoning—judgments based on outcomes—rather than to deontological reasoning—judgments based on rules or duties.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Okonkwo's proposal about the specificity of the impairment?

- A) Participants who slept fewer than four hours performed worse on both consequentialist and deontological moral dilemmas than participants who slept eight hours.
 - B) Sleep-deprived participants reported feeling more fatigued than rested participants, which correlated with slower response times on all types of cognitive tasks.
 - C) Brain imaging showed that sleep deprivation reduced activity equally across all cortical regions, not just the prefrontal cortex.
 - D) Sleep-deprived participants performed significantly worse than rested participants on moral dilemmas requiring outcome-based evaluation but showed no impairment on dilemmas that could be resolved by applying a fixed moral rule.
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